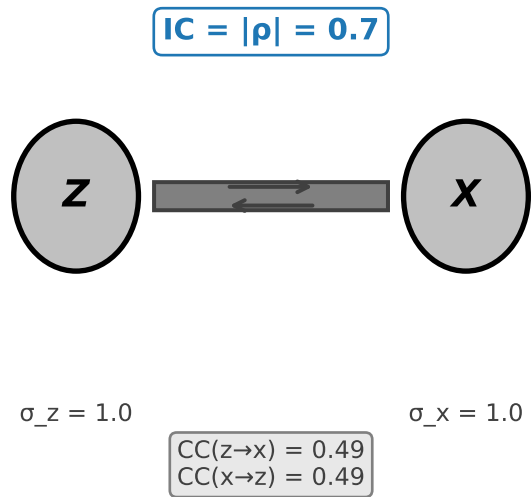
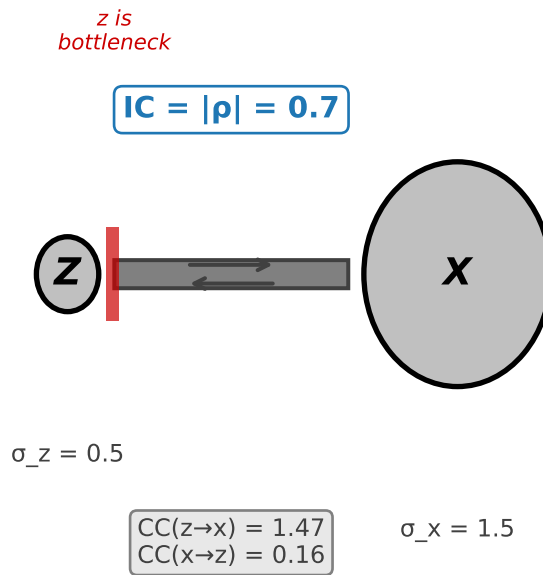


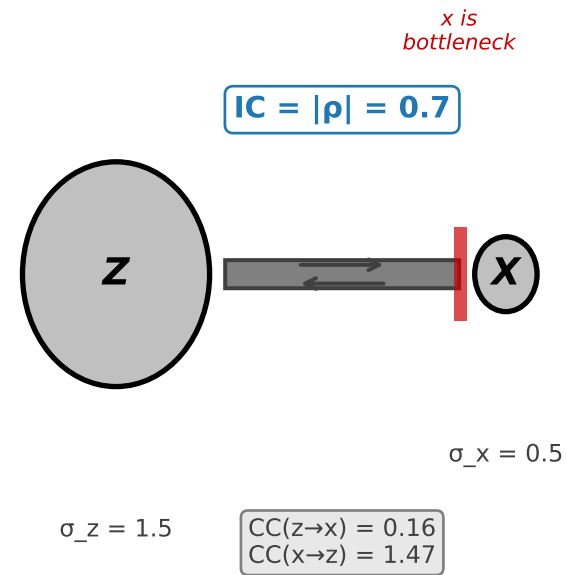
(A) Balanced: $\sigma_z \approx \sigma_x$



(B) z constrains: $\sigma_z < \sigma_x$



(C) x constrains: $\sigma_x < \sigma_z$



Key insight: $IC = |\rho|$ is the same across all scenarios (inference is variance-independent).
The bottleneck affects Control Coupling (CC), not Inference Coupling (IC).